Naples, FL inventory table:

ID	Name	Type (park/field/court/trail)	Primary Use	Location (address/area)	Condition (Good/Fair/Poor)	Size / Qty	Amenities	Accessibility (ADA notes)	Notes	Park Demand (Low/Med/High)	Potential for Expansion (Low/Med/High)
1	Cambier Park	Park	Signature park w/ bandshell, tennis, playground	755 8th Ave S	Good (playground closed pending replacement)	N/A	Bandshell; tennis center nearby; courts; picnic pavilion; restrooms; open lawn	Sidewalk access; central downtown setting; general ADA facilities; (playground currently closed)	Core downtown park hosting concerts/events; heavy visitation	High	Low
2	Fleischmann Park	Park	Athletics, playgrounds, skate park	1600 Fleischmann Blvd	Good	15 acres	Lighted racquetball; basketball/volleyball/pickleball courts; football/soccer fields; skate area; splash pad; playgrounds; pavilions; restrooms	Community center and facilities with accessible indoor spaces; paved circulation	Multi-age sports/rec hub; frequent programs and events	High	Medium
3	Lowdermilk Park	Park	Beach access, concessions, picnic	1301 Gulf Shore Blvd N	Good (ongoing coastal recovery context)	N/A	Beach; gazebos; picnic tables; sand volleyball; restrooms/showers; concessions	ADA beach access mats; designated accessible parking paths	High-use beachfront access; water quality/advisories monitored seasonally	High	Low
4	Naples Pier	Special Use	Iconic fishing pier + beach	25 12th Ave S	Fair (active rebuild/design program)	N/A	Pier; restrooms; showers; concessions; beach access	ADA beach access mat at beach; rebuilt elements planned in design	Pier under approved redesign concepts after storm impacts	High	Low
5	Baker Park	Park	Riverfront trail loop + fitness	50 Riverside Cir	Good (new park, opened 2019)	15 acres	Loop trail; river overlooks; pavilions; fitness stations; playground; splash features (status varies)	Paved paths; bridge to Greenway; site has accessible parking/routes	New riverfront destination connected to Greenway	High	Low
6	Gordon River Greenway	Linear Park / Trail	Riverfront boardwalk + trail	1596 Golden Gate Pkwy	Good	~140 acres; ~2.5 miles trail	Boardwalks; asphalt trails; wildlife viewing; access points; kayak launch	Paved/boardwalk surfaces; multiple accessible trailheads	Regional greenway spine; ecological corridor	High	Medium
7	Naples Zoo at Caribbean Gardens	Special Use Facility	Accredited zoo + botanical garden	1590 Goodlette-Frank Rd	Good	~43 acres	Main paved loop; shows; restrooms; concessions; gardens; animal exhibits	Paved primary paths; accessible restrooms; wheelchair spaces at theater	AZA-accredited; strong conservation/education use	High	Low
8	River Park Community Center	Recreation Center	Gym, pool, programs, playground	301 11th St N	Good	~11,000 sq ft building + outdoor	Computer lab; fitness room; auditorium; meeting rooms; pool; basketball pavilion; playground	Indoor accessible facilities; accessible pool amenities; paved campus	Neighborhood anchor in historically underserved area	High	Medium
9	Anthony Park	Neighborhood Park	Playground, basketball, open lawn	150 13th St N (area near River Park)	Good (neighborhood park scale)	N/A	Playground; courts; picnic tables; riverside setting; small dock (per city/visitor info)	Paved routes; level site; basic ADA parking access	Small local park serving River Park neighborhood	Med	Low
10	Arthur L. Allen Tennis Center	Special Use Sports	Clay courts + pro shop	730 8th St S	Good (well-maintained Hydro-Grid courts)	12 Har-Tru lighted courts	Chickee shade huts; cold-water fountains; pro shop; programs/USTA play	Accessible spectator areas and routes within Cambier complex	Regionally notable public tennis center	High	Low
11	Norris Community Center	Recreation / Cultural	Theater, classrooms, events	755 8th Ave S	Good	Multi-room facility	Auditorium/stage; meeting rooms; art gallery; classes; amphitheater	Purpose-built civic venue; accessible entrances/interiors	Downtown cultural programming hub next to Cambier	High	Low
12	Seagate Beach Access	Beach Access	Neighborhood beach walkover	Seagate Dr (North Gulfshore Access)	Good	N/A	Beach access; small parking lot (county); path to beach	Beach access path; at-grade walks; limited amenities	Serves Seagate/N. Gulfshore area; parking constrained	Med	Low
13	Clam Pass Park	Beach & Preserve	Boardwalk, mangroves, concessions	465 Seagate Dr	Good	35 acres; ~0.75-mile boardwalk	Tram/boardwalk to beach; restrooms; concessions; chair/cabana rentals	Paved segments/boardwalk; accessible tram to beach	High-demand coastal access with preserve setting	High	Low
14	Riverside Circle Boat Ramp	Boat Launch	Public canal boat launch (city)	Near 50 Riverside Cir (see note)	Fair (limited capacity/area)	N/A	Small ramp/launch area (assumed city); parking limited	At-grade access; basic facilities (assumed)	Listed locally but primary city launch is Naples Landing	Med	Low
15	Freedom Park	Passive / Memorial	Stormwater preserve + trails	1515 Golden Gate Pkwy	Good	~50 acres	Boardwalks/paths; interpretive signage; wetlands vistas; memorial elements	Paved/boardwalk paths; accessible viewing areas	Water-quality/flood-mitigation park with education	Med	Low
16	Bayfront Park Plaza	Plaza / Open Space	Hardscape plaza + events	Bayfront Dr (Bayfront district)	Good	N/A	Waterfront promenades; brick pathways; retail/food adjacency	Paved, step-free promenades; curb ramps; structured parking	Privately led mixed-use public realm; events potential	Med	Low
17	Sugden Regional Park	Special Use Lakefront	Lakefront paths, sailing, playground	4284 Avalon Dr	Good	60-acre Lake Avalon	Beach; sailing/waterski programs (incl. adaptive); playground; path; pavilions; restrooms	Paved loop path and amenities; adaptive sailing programs	Regional lakefront recreation and programming	High	Low
18	NAACP Youth Park	Neighborhood Park	Playground, shelter, open grass	River Park area	Good (community pocket park)	N/A	Play area; small shelter; open lawn (community use)	Paved neighborhood sidewalks; basic ADA access	Neighborhood-scale asset supporting youth activities	Med	Low

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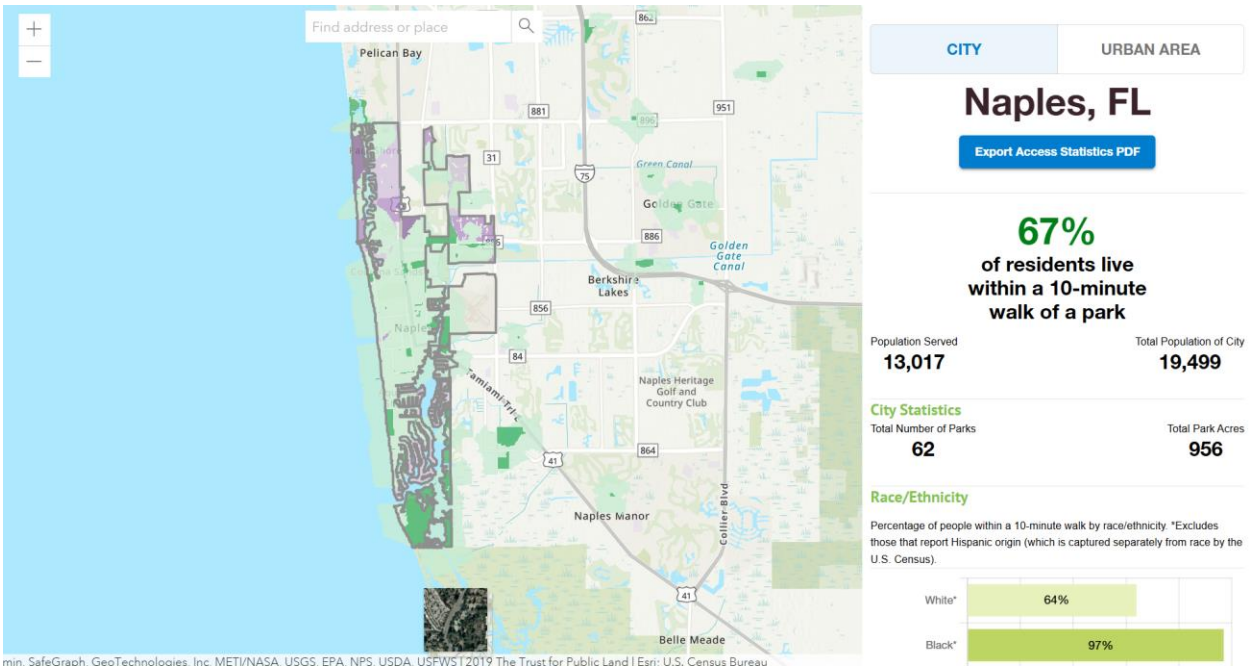
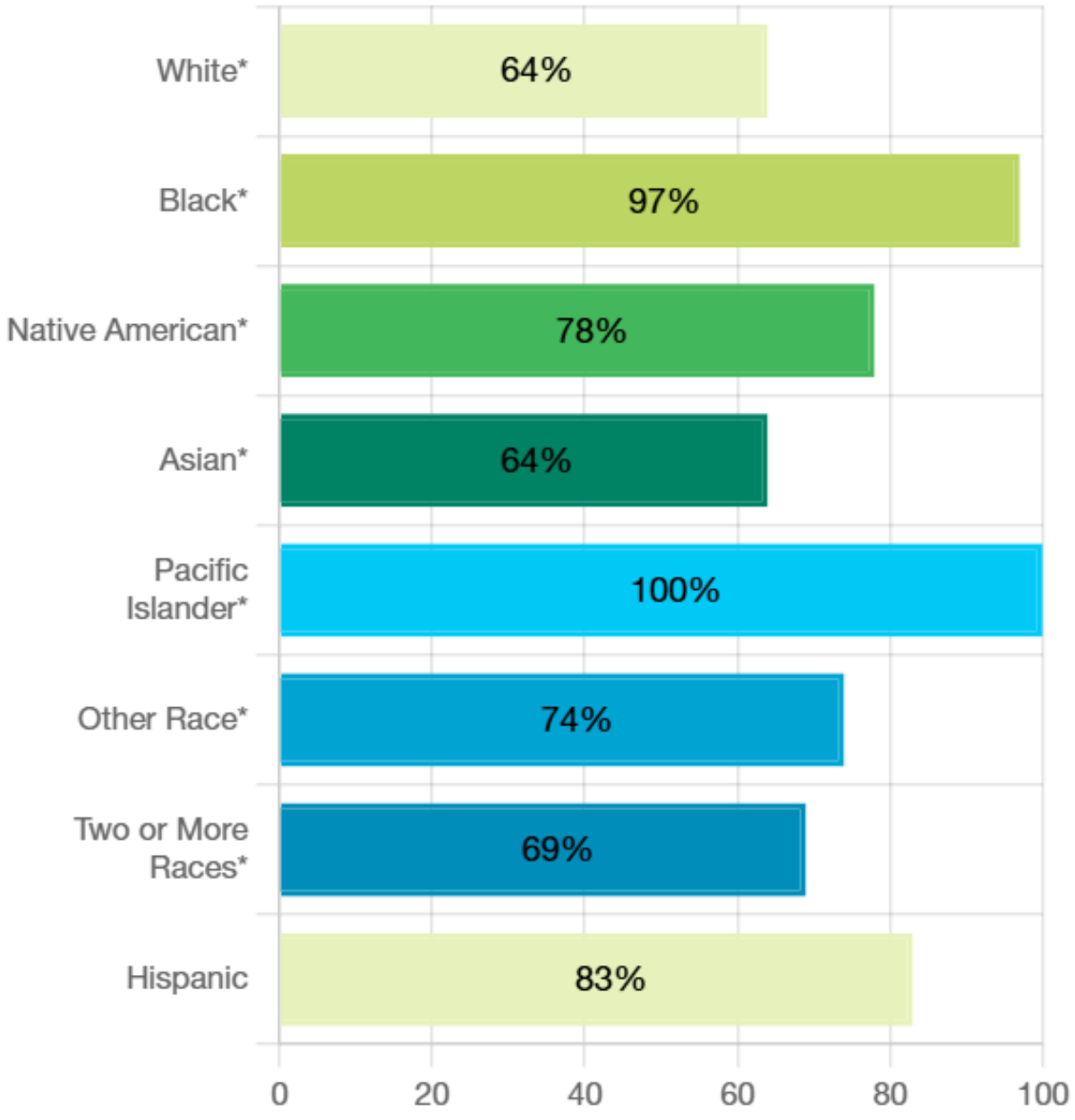
Naples, FL existing Access/Need view:



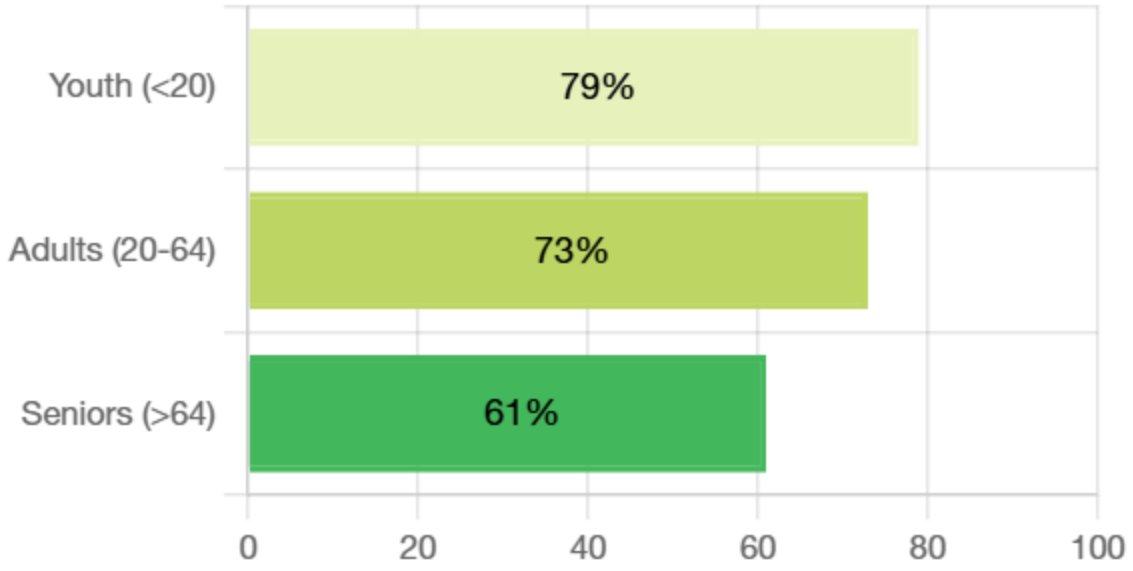
Race/Ethnicity

Percentage of people within a 10-minute walk by race/ethnicity. *Excludes those that report Hispanic origin (which is captured separately from race by the U.S. Census).



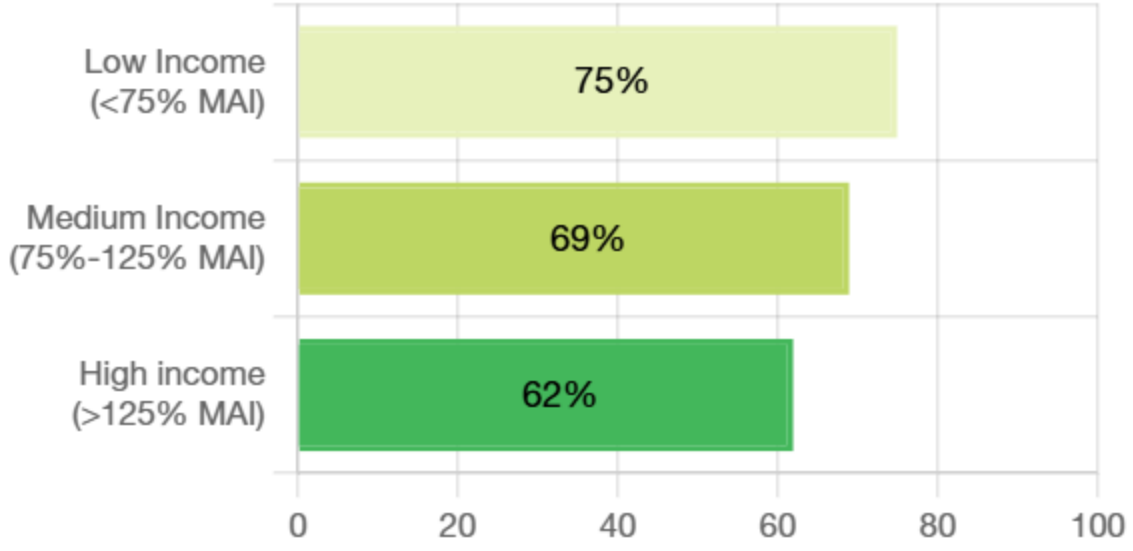
Age

Percentage of people within a 10-minute walk by age group.

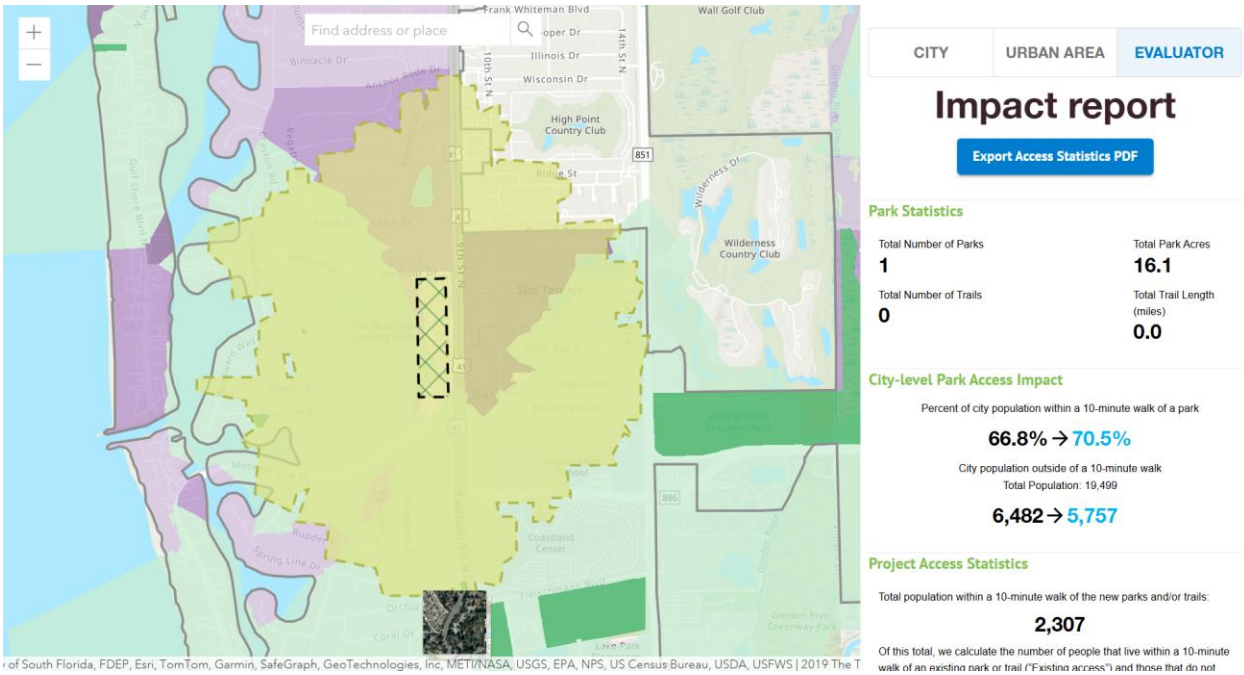


Income

Percentage of households within a 10-minute walk by income. MAI - Median Area Income, which is the median income of the urban area.



Additional park ParkEvaluator view:



City-level Park Access Impact

Percent of city population within a 10-minute walk of a park

66.8% → 70.5%

City population outside of a 10-minute walk

Total Population: 19,499

6,482 → 5,757

Project Access Statistics

Total population within a 10-minute walk of the new parks and/or trails:

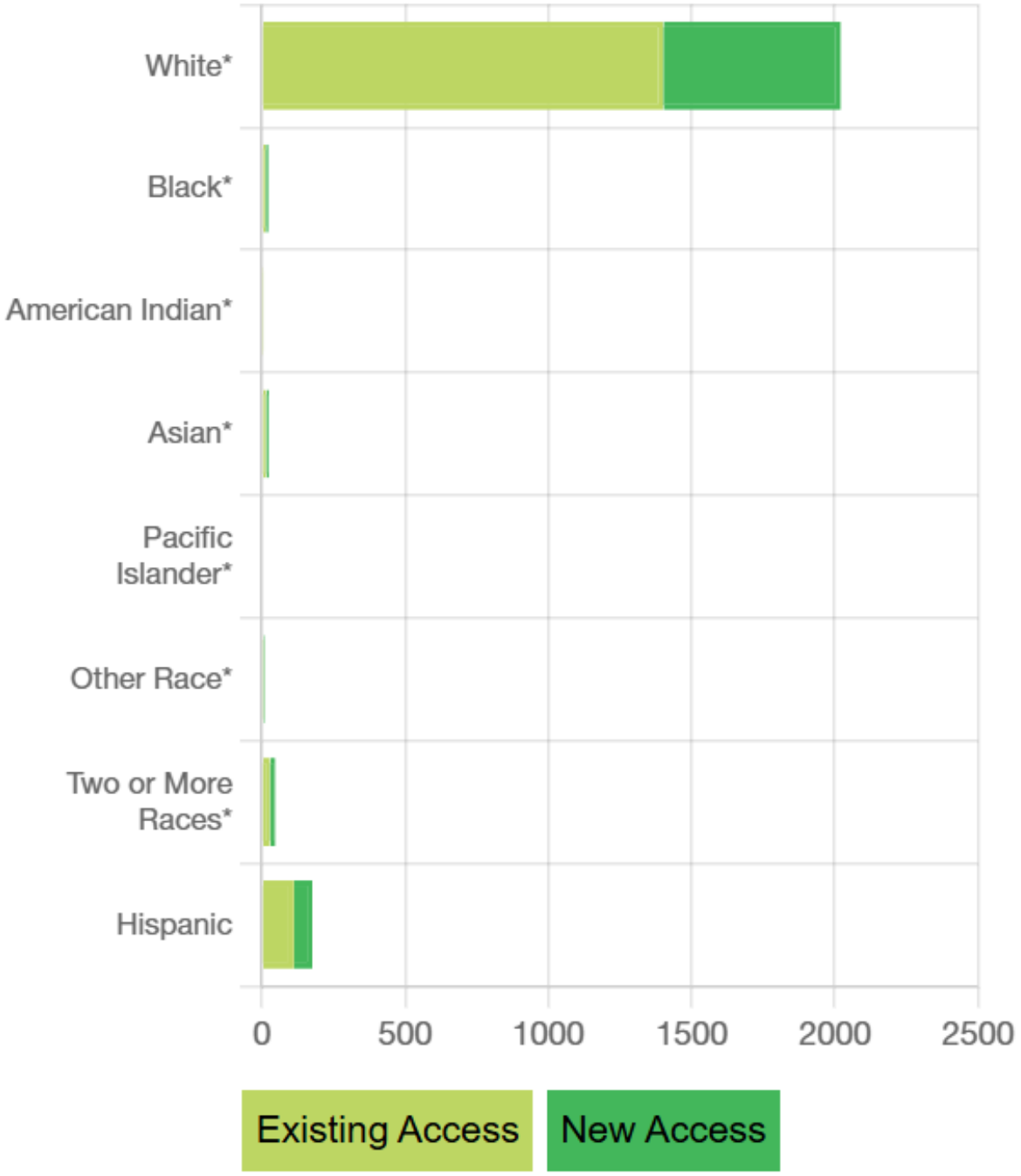
2,307

Of this total, we calculate the number of people that live within a 10-minute walk of an existing park or trail ("Existing access") and those that do not ("New access"):

Existing access	New access
1,582	725

Race/Ethnicity

Number of residents within a 10-minute walk by race/ethnicity. *Excludes those that report Hispanic origin (which is captured separately from race by the U.S. Census).



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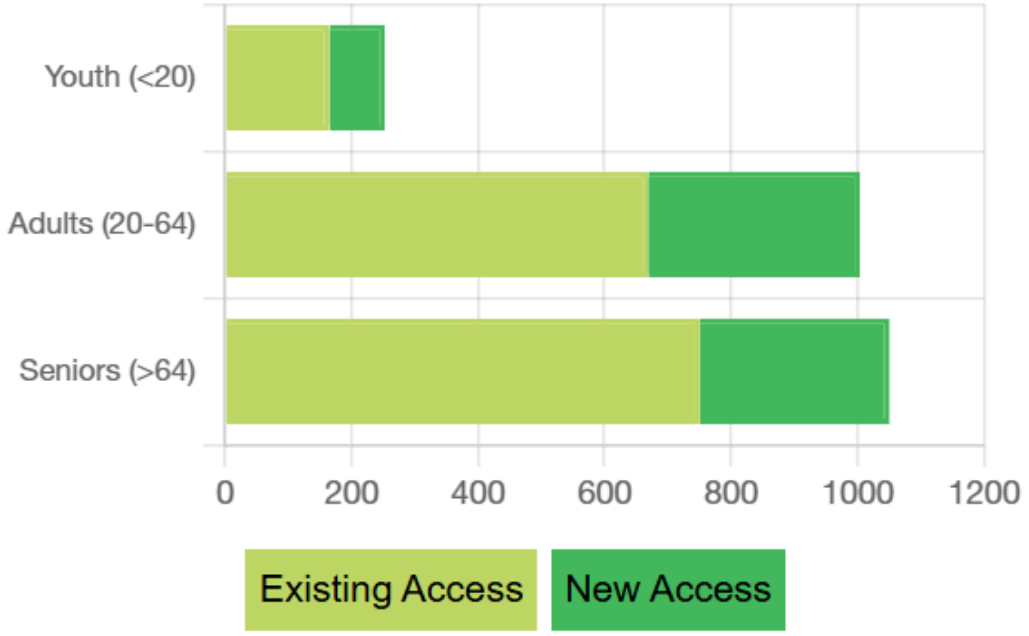

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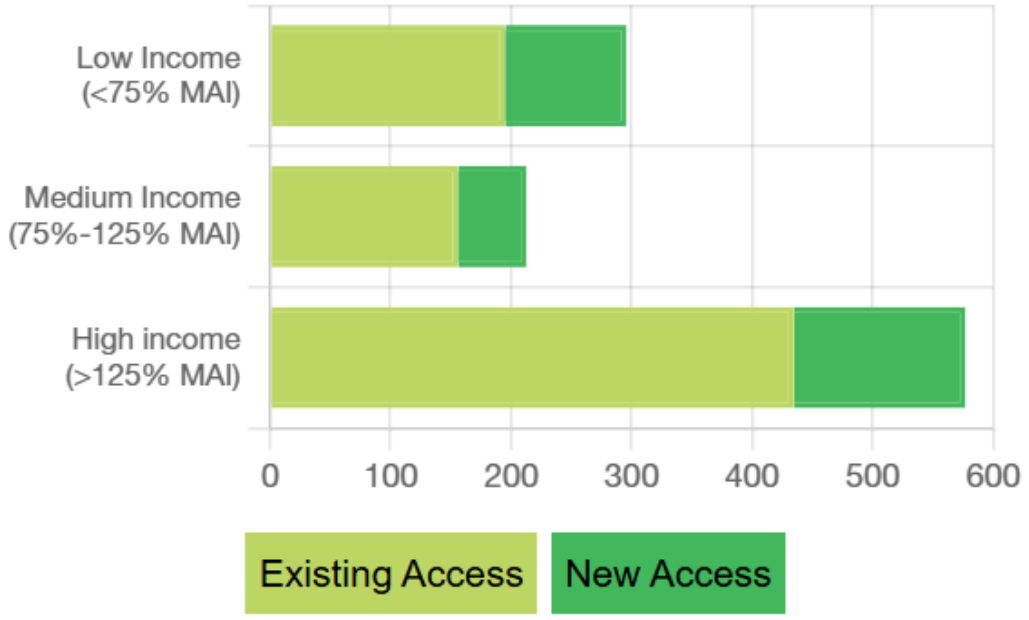
Number of households within a 10-minute walk by income. MAI = Median Area Income, which is the median income of the urban area.



Reviewing the inventory and TPL ParkServe 10-minute walk analysis, the most significant coverage gap identified in the inventory is east of Goodlette-Frank Road where no city-owned parks exist and there are a cluster of higher-density neighborhoods outside the walkability radius. A small neighborhood park or trailhead node in this area would immediately increase access to more than 700 residents, particularly the year-round renters and workforce households that are not served by beachfront parks. This observation confirms a significant equity and service distribution imbalance in the Naples system (Trust for Public Land, 2024).

Summary of Findings

1. Where I inventoried

I conducted an inventory of 18 publicly-owned and -accessible parks and recreation facilities within the City of Naples municipal boundary. Included only city-owned or publicly-managed facilities; not HOA or private club properties. Tried to include a mix of community parks, special-use facilities, beach access areas, passive parks, recreation centers, trails, and two water assets. Inventory captures a cross-section of Naples' park "typologies", ranging from internationally-recognized beachfront "drivers" like Naples Pier and Lowdermilk Park to inland neighborhood amenities like Anthony Park and the River Park Community Center. I also added a single "gap" line item for a missing greenway segment that has come up in prior planning discussions and directly ties to future system build-out. In aggregate, these assets capture how Naples' park system is both an extension of the city's coastal geography/tourism economy and the constrained amount of non-waterfront public land suitable for future development (Young et al., 2024).

2. Key finding from the inventory

One spatial pattern was immediately apparent: the largest, highest-amenity, and most heavily-marketed parks are all located west of US-41 and, in particular, along the Gulf shoreline, while the city's center and east side are home to a series of smaller, more single-purpose parks. Visitor volume is naturally heaviest in coastal parks, which are destination points for both full-time residents and seasonal tourists, further crowding out the demand for neighborhood-scale facilities inland. As a result, the Naples park system is not only highly uneven in terms of walkable access, but also unequal in terms of both recreation experience and investment value. The system is, in a sense, "two-tiered"—a premium coastal set of parks that anchor Naples' identity, and a more modest set of inland parks serving year-round residents, especially workers, renters, and families (Cao et al., 2022).

3. Insight from ParkServe + ParkEvaluator

ParkServe data confirmed the lack of balance, with its 10-minute walk access map illustrating a number of "coverage holes" east of Goodlette-Frank Road. This same area also darkens to a deeper red in the Park Need Index, signaling a higher percentage of permanent residents, households with low private amenity access, and low park proximity than the west side of the

city. By entering the coordinates of this gap into the ParkEvaluator tool and testing placement of a small neighborhood park or trail node, I was able to see how the model predicted more than 700 additional residents would gain walkable access to a park as a result, a very large impact for a single, modest scale site (Hindman et al., 2020; Trust for Public Land, 2024). This result suggests the Naples area may not need more beachfront sprawl but instead more infill to address these systemic access disparities.

4. Caveat about the data

ParkServe is a useful tool for access analysis, but it does not provide information on asset condition, maintenance backlog, year-round usability, or limited-seasonality service gaps — all of which are key pieces of the Naples puzzle. It also does not account for private amenities, including HOA parks, hotel pools, and beach clubs, which may cause the inland areas to appear more underserved than they might subjectively feel to some residents. That's a deliberate omission, and a valid one, as the assignment — and national standards, for that matter — are squarely about public, free-access parks, not private ones. A second limitation is that the ParkServe dataset represents 2023 conditions and may not yet account for recent improvements, damage from hurricanes, or planned CIP projects (Trust for Public Land, 2024; Burrowes et al., 2022).

5. Correlation between inventory and ParkServe insights

My table verified what ParkServe suggested: The inventory is geographically weighted towards west Naples and east side has fewer assets, multi-purpose parks and public entry points to recreation. The fact that both the manual table and national dataset highlighted the same service gap strengthens the case for fixing it in a future plan recommendation. It also demonstrates that qualitative field knowledge and quantitative GIS tools arrive at the same conclusion — meaning Naples has a locational equity issue, not just an amenities mismatch (Jeon et al., 2023).

6. How these findings inform the larger plan

This also immediately justified the decision to include an “access equity” metric in the Naples strategic plan tied to future capital allocation and performance dashboard tracking, and to look for opportunities to diversify the park “types” offered inland (versus again and again reinvesting in the waterfront core). This in turn is perfectly consistent with the larger resilience/workforce retention/livability themes already identified for Naples — in other words, system gaps are not just recreation issues, but also economic/social ones. A new east-side neighborhood park or greenway connector is not just filling a map void; it would materially support the residents who are least served by the current system and most dependent on it year-round (Hughey et al., 2025; NRPA, 2023).

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